REPORT ON MY CV WEBSITE

Personal CV Website

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reg no: CPR/5459/23

course code: INS 322

course name: Web design and management

task: cat 1

Introduction

A report on the CV website done by Dorcas Lotodo and submitted on the 17th of March at 10am to enhance skills in HTML and its use in structuring web pages.

Information on the website

the website is my personal CV as Dorcas Lotodo, a Bachelor of arts student in Communication and Public relations at Moi University. The main goal of the site is to present my academic background, work experience, skills, contact, referees details to potential employers and to foreshow my ability to create well structured, clear, professional and presentation to my lecturer.

The website is made up of three HTML pages:

index.html - it works as the home page and it carries a short profile, a navigation bar at the top to move to the other pages, a section with a photo, an education table and a footer. This file also acts as the main landing page of the website.

myinfo/experience.html – this link leads to the experience and skills page that details university activities that I indulged in, a list of the skills that I managed to gain and my hobbies and a table of the roles undertake.

myinfo/contact.html – The Contact page provides email and contact details along with referees listed on a table incase they are needed by a potential employer.

All the three pages do share a navigation bar linking all the three websites and a consistent footer with copyright information.

Design choices

The website has been built using HTML only without CSS as the requirements of the assignment

simply stated so hence all visual structures such as tables and horizontal lines were achieved by HTML elements and attributes alone.

Page Layout

Each page contains a navigation bar, followed by a horizontal line to visually separate sections. A page header is used to show the section title. Content sections are enclosed in <section> tags and each page ends with a footer that repeats the navigation links to enable easy accessibility from either end of the page that the user is in and a copyright line.

Tables

tables were used in every page of the website to enable the structuring of the information clearly. In the index.html file, which is the also the homepage, tables have been used in the my profile to structure the images and the "my profile" into different columns and rows to make the text more readable and presentable. The education history is also displayed in a bordered table style and the same style used in the experience table and in the contact page its also used in the referees table and get in touch table. Though the Home page on the profile section uses boredeless table with a border of "0" achieving a 2-column layout without CSS.

Typography and Structure

I used the heading tags (h1, h2, h3) to create a visual hierarchy for example h1 for the main title and the subsequent titles in the subsequent heading tags. H1 is used for the main title and the h2 used for the subtitle and h3 for individual section headings. Paragraphs which are written with the tag <p> are used for descriptive text and unordered lists which are used for the skills and hobbies on the experience page.

Navigation

the navigation links with the tags <nav> are used to enhance accessibility of the other website pages and are placed on the top and bottom of every page to allow users to navigate throughout he website without having to scroll with the | character used as a visual separator for the link.

How the layout was managed

the layout was managed through html in the following ways:

the tables were used for the website alignment

horizontal rules <hr/> have been used as visual separators among the sections giving it a sectioned and readable structure.

Table attributes such as cellpadding are used on the tables to control spacing with border = “1” used to make the grids visible and border = “0” to make them invisible.
HTML entities: Special characters such as (-), ampersand (&) are written using HTML entities (&ndash, &amp etc ensure that they are rendered correctly across all browsers.

File and folder structure

The main index.html resides inside the root folder while the experience.html and the contact.html are palced in the myinfo folder that resides in the root folder. The images sit in the images folder that is a subfolder of the root folder while the Readme.txt has been saved in the root folder. This keeps the project organized and the file paths consistent.

Evidence of validation

All the three HTML pages have been checked using the W3C Markup Validation Service (https://validator.w3.org). The validator is used to make sure that the code is compliant to the HTML standards and free from errors that could cause inconsistency rendering across browsers.
The key aspects that were checked during validation include: correct DOCTYPE declaration, proper nesting of HTML elements, valid use of attributes, presence of alt attributes on images and correct use of HTML character entities.
No errors were found during validation although there were warnings on the depricated nature of some of the older html styling methods of the file resulting to the validator.w3 suggesting the alternative use of CSS which we were initially warned against its use in this project.

The validation process included;
Copying and pasting each .html file into the “Validate by Direct input” Tab and the pages did pass the validation with no errors but several warnings due to the deprecated use of html for styling web pages.
I got back a popup message that said “document checking completed” signalling that I had finished validating the website and that feedback has bee returned.
The following screenshots are proof of validation:

Showing results for uploaded file experience.html (checked with vnu 26.3.10)

Checker Input

Show ☐ source ☐ outline ☐ image report ☐ errors & warnings only Options...

Check by file upload Choose File No file chosen

Uploaded files with .xhtml or .xht extensions are parsed using the XML parser.

Check

Use the Message Filtering button below to hide/show particular messages, and to see total counts of errors and warnings.

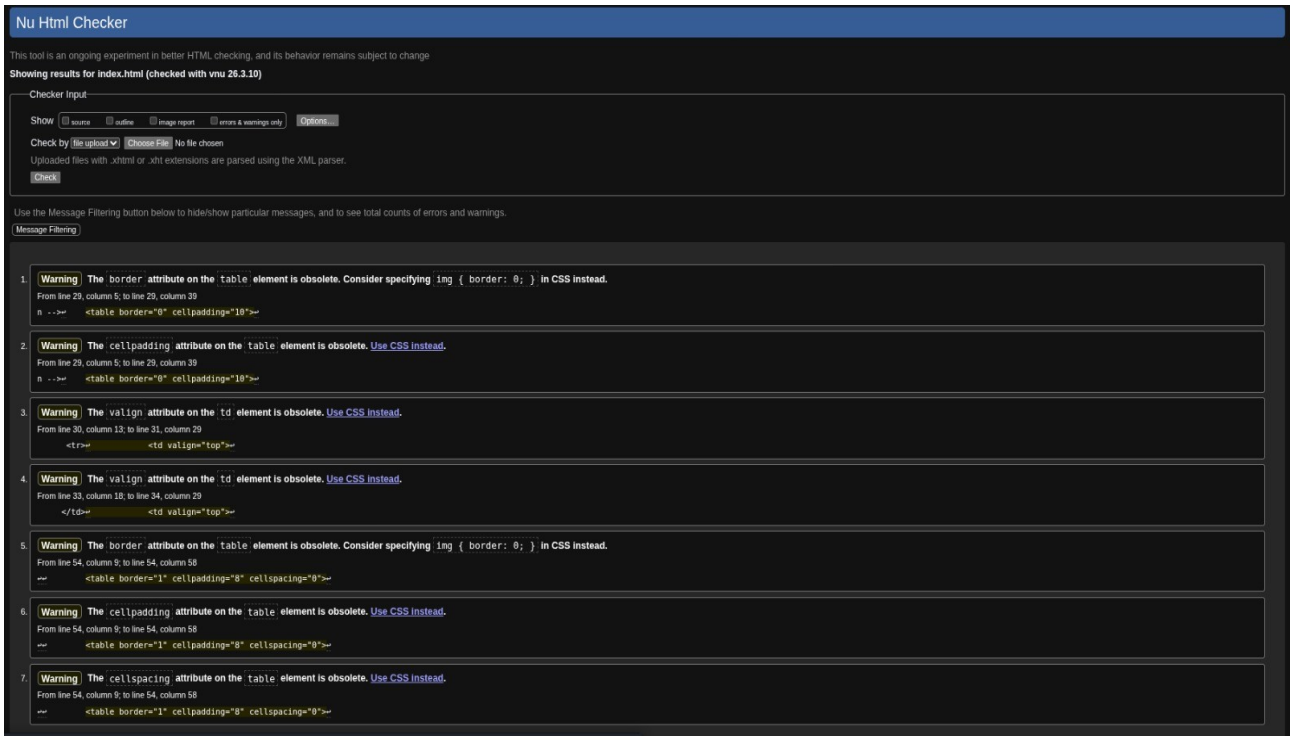
Message Filtering

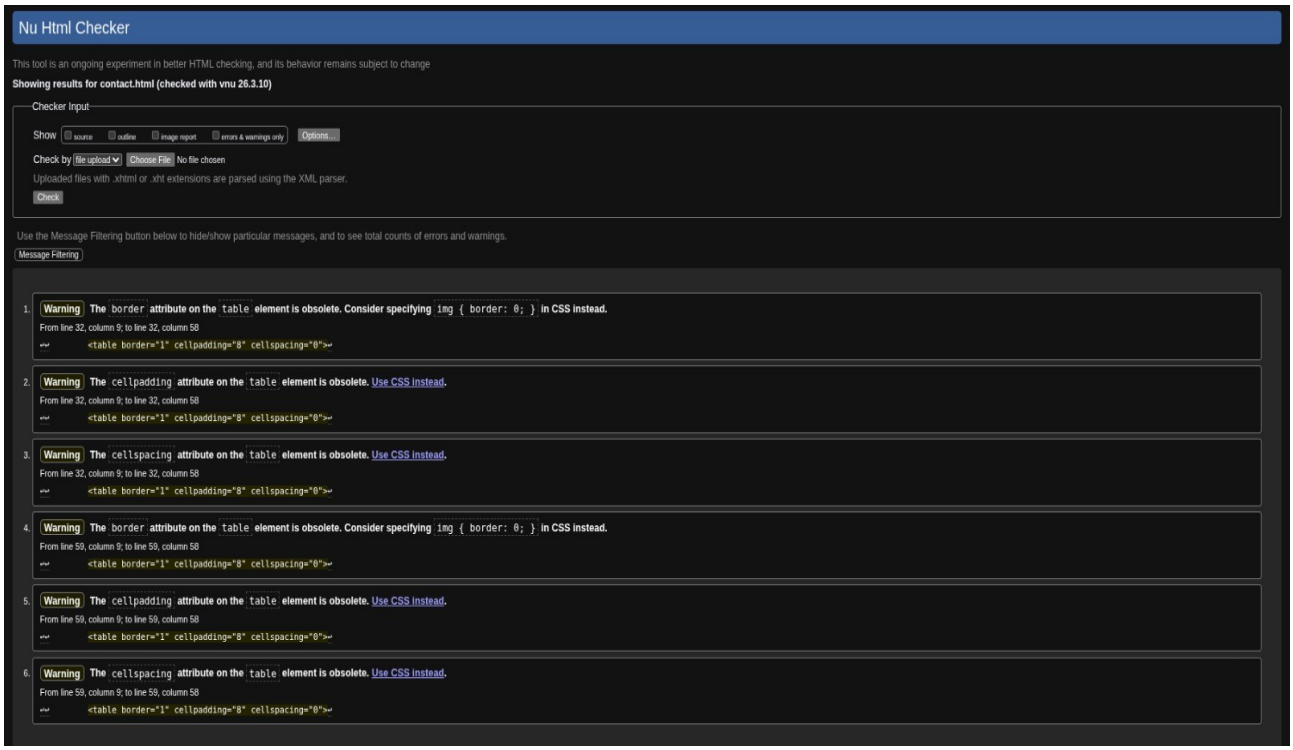
1. **Warning** **The `border` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. Consider specifying `img { border: 0; }` in CSS instead.**
   From line 47, column 9; to line 47, column 58
   ↩↩ `<table border="1" cellpadding="8" cellspacing="0">`↩
2. **Warning** **The `cellpadding` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. Use CSS instead.**
   From line 47, column 9; to line 47, column 58
   ↩↩ `<table border="1" cellpadding="8" cellspacing="0">`↩
3. **Warning** **The `cellspacing` attribute on the `table` element is obsolete. Use CSS instead.**
   From line 47, column 9; to line 47, column 58
   ↩↩ `<table border="1" cellpadding="8" cellspacing="0">`↩

Document checking completed.

Used the HTML parser.

Total execution time 3 milliseconds.





Problems encountered

1. fear of doing something new – tiresome to type doctype, very repetitive

due to it being the first time that I'm doing a full project with the use of the html, I was scared of trying out something new and the fear mad it seem kinda hard and I was demotivated really fast. After a while, when I was on the second page for my website, I found out that I was enjoying seeing the website coming into shape. And then came my other problem, it became quite tiresome and pretty repetitive to write out the structure of the page every single time and after some consultations with some fo my experienced friends, they did telll me that there was a shortcut to writing the structure which was typing the exclamation mark key (shift + 1) and pressing enter which reduced my work by a load.

2. achieving a 2 column profile layout without css – layering without CSS

by trying to make the website more presentable, I had to figure out how to arrange the content in a presentable way for the viewer. I decided to google about it using the prompt "how to layout the website without using css" and came by a stack overflow website which advised me to use the table attribute.

3. navigation across the pages - figuring out how to move to the parent folder

when I read the instructions, I was left wondering how to navigate through the websites using links when the index.html was in the root folder while the experience.html and contact.html were in a subfolder. After going through the notes, I found out about the ../filename and I made use of it for navigation among the different website pages.

4.visual spacing without css

Controlling the visual spacing was somehow difficult like adding space between paragraphs

5.deprecated HTML attributes

some attributes such as cellpadding, valign are considered deprecated or non conforming to HTML5 and the w3 vslidator did flag them as warnings. The attributes were used because CSS was not allowed.

6.deploying the websites to enable running of the virtual browsers

I tried deploying the website to enable the viewing of the website on different web pages. I opened a Github account and followed the steps in you tube on how to deploy a website. I managed to deploy it but every virtual browser that I tried needed me to subscribe to a payment plan which was very demotivating.

7.being satisfied with the website result

after having a look at my website and comparing it to the websites that I visit daily, I came to unerstand the power of css because of how demotivating the plain look was to me. Although, I did manage to try and a,ke it as presentable as possible.